



International Standard

ISO/IEC 17024

Conformity assessment — General requirements for bodies operating certification of persons

*Évaluation de la conformité — Exigences générales pour les
organismes de certification procédant à la certification de
personnes*

**Third edition
2026-03**



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Foreword

ISO (the International Organization for Standardization) and IEC (the International Electrotechnical Commission) form the specialized system for worldwide standardization. National bodies that are members of ISO or IEC participate in the development of International Standards through technical committees established by the respective organization to deal with particular fields of technical activity. ISO and IEC technical committees collaborate in fields of mutual interest. Other international organizations, governmental and non-governmental, in liaison with ISO and IEC, also take part in the work.

The procedures used to develop this document and those intended for its further maintenance are described in the ISO/IEC Directives, Part 1. In particular, the different approval criteria needed for the different types of document should be noted. This document was drafted in accordance with the editorial rules of the ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2 (see www.iso.org/directives or www.iec.ch/members_experts/refdocs).

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This document was prepared by the ISO Committee on Conformity Assessment (CASCO), in collaboration with the European Committee for Standardization (CEN) Technical Committee CEN/CLC/JTC 1, *Criteria for conformity assessment bodies*, in accordance with the Agreement on technical cooperation between ISO and CEN (Vienna Agreement).

This third edition cancels and replaces the second edition (ISO/IEC 17024:2012), which has been technically revised.

The main changes are as follows:

- addition or revision of terms and definitions;
- additional requirements for the use of artificial intelligence (AI) added in 6.5;
- alignment with the PROC/33 text that establishes common elements for standards developed by CASCO.

Any feedback or questions on this document should be directed to the user's national standards body. A complete listing of these bodies can be found at www.iso.org/members.html and www.iec.ch/national-committees.

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Introduction

This document has been developed with the objective of achieving and promoting a globally accepted set of requirements and principles for bodies operating certification of persons. Certification of persons is one means of providing assurance that the certified person meets the requirements identified in the certification scheme. Confidence in the respective schemes for certification of persons is achieved by means of a globally accepted process of assessment and periodic re-assessments of the competence of certified persons.

However, it is necessary to distinguish between situations where schemes for certification of persons are justified and situations where other forms of qualification are more appropriate. The development of schemes for certification of persons, in response to the ever-increasing velocity of technological innovation and growing specialization of personnel, can compensate for variations in education and training and thus facilitate the global job market. Alternatives to certification can still be necessary for job positions where public services, official or governmental operations are concerned.

This document can serve as the basis for the recognition of the bodies operating certification of persons, in order to facilitate their acceptance at the national, regional and international levels. Only the harmonization of the methodologies for developing and maintaining schemes for certification of persons can establish the environment for mutual recognition and the global exchange of persons.

This document specifies requirements which ensure that bodies operating certification of persons operate in a consistent, comparable and reliable manner. The requirements in this document are considered to be general requirements for bodies operating certification of persons. Certification of persons can only occur when there is a certification scheme. Schemes for certification of persons are based on market needs or demand or can be required by governments.

This document can be used for accreditation or peer assessment or designation by governmental authorities, scheme owners and others.

Conformity assessment — General requirements for bodies operating certification of persons

1 Scope

This document specifies principles and requirements for a body operating certification of persons and includes the development and maintenance of a scheme for certification of persons.

NOTE 1 For the purposes of this document, the term "certification body" is used in place of the full term "body operating certification of persons", and the term "certification scheme" is used in place of the full term "scheme for certification of persons".

NOTE 2 [Annex A](#) contains principles for certification of persons.

2 Normative references

The following documents are referred to in the text in such a way that some or all of their content constitutes requirements of this document. For dated references, only the edition cited applies. For undated references, the latest edition of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

ISO/IEC 17000, *Conformity assessment — Vocabulary and general principles*

3 Terms and definitions

For the purposes of this document, the terms and definitions given in ISO/IEC 17000 and the following apply.

ISO and IEC maintain terminology databases for use in standardization at the following addresses:

- ISO Online browsing platform: available at <https://www.iso.org/obp>
- IEC Electropedia: available at <https://www.electropedia.org/>

3.1 certification process

activities by which a *certification body* (3.7) determines that a person fulfils *certification requirements* (3.4)

Note 1 to entry: Certification process includes application, *assessment* (3.12), decision on certification, *recertification* (3.30), and issuance of *certificates* (3.6). It can include *surveillance* (3.29). [Annex B](#) can assist in the understanding of these terms.

3.2 certification scheme scheme for certification of persons

set of rules and procedures that specifies the *competence* (3.9) criteria and other requirements related to specific categories of skills or occupations of persons and specifies the methodology for performing certification of persons

3.3 scheme owner

organization responsible for developing and maintaining a *certification scheme* (3.2)

Note 1 to entry: The organization can be the *certification body* (3.7) itself, a governmental authority, or other bodies.

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3.4

certification requirements

set of specified requirements including requirements of the *certification scheme* (3.2) to be fulfilled in order to establish or maintain certification

3.5

scope of certification

specific job(s), role(s) or function(s) that a *certified person* (3.20) can perform competently

3.6

certificate

attestation by a *certification body* (3.7) indicating that the *certified person* (3.20) has fulfilled the *certification requirements* (3.4)

Note 1 to entry: The certificate can take the form of a document, card or other medium.

3.7

certification body

body operating certification of persons

conformity assessment body performing certification of persons in accordance with *certification schemes* (3.2)

3.8

certification mark

mark issued by a *certification body* (3.7), indicating that a person has fulfilled *certification requirements* (3.4)

Note 1 to entry: The mark can be a logo or a symbol.

3.9

competence

ability (3.10) to apply knowledge and skills to achieve intended results

3.10

ability

person's capacity to perform a task

3.11

qualification

demonstrated education, training or work experience

3.12

assessment

evaluation of a person's fulfilment of the *certification requirements* (3.4) specified in the *certification scheme* (3.2)

3.13

examination

part of the *assessment* (3.12) which measures a *candidate's* (3.19) *competence* (3.9) by one or more means, such as written, oral, practical and observational, as defined in the *certification scheme* (3.2)

3.14

examiner

person competent to conduct and score an *examination* (3.13), where the examination requires judgement on the *competence* (3.9) of persons

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3.15

invigilation

process of administering *an examination* (3.13) or supervising *candidates* (3.19) during an examination to prevent fraudulent examination behaviour, unauthorized disclosure of examination material or other misconduct

Note 1 to entry: Invigilation can include the following: an *invigilator* (3.16) physically or remotely present viewing an examination in real time, or an *examiner* (3.14) or invigilator physically or remotely present viewing a practical examination which may be recorded and reviewed later.

Note 2 to entry: Invigilation by *artificial intelligence* (3.31) may also be used provided it meets the requirements of this document.

3.16

invigilator

person authorized by the *certification body* (3.7) to perform the *invigilation* (3.15), but does not evaluate the *competence* (3.9) of the *candidate* (3.19)

Note 1 to entry: Other terms used in practice are, for example, proctor, test administrator, supervisor.

3.17

personnel

individuals, internal or external, of the *certification body* (3.7) carrying out activities for the certification body

Note 1 to entry: These include committee members, volunteers, contractors, personnel of external bodies or persons acting on the certification body's behalf.

3.18

applicant

person who has submitted an application for certification

3.19

candidate

person who has fulfilled application requirements

Note 1 to entry: The application requirements can include prerequisites.

3.20

certified person

person who has fulfilled and continues to fulfil the *certification requirements* (3.4) after the decision to certify has been taken by the *certification body* (3.7)

3.21

impartiality

objectivity with regard to the activities of the *certification body* (3.7), its *certification process* (3.1) and its outcome

Note 1 to entry: Other terms that are useful in conveying the element of impartiality are freedom from undue influence, freedom from conflicts of interest, absence of *bias* (3.23), neutrality and lack of prejudice.

3.22

fairness

equal opportunity for success provided to each *applicant* (3.18), *candidate* (3.19) and *certified person* (3.20) in the *certification process* (3.1)

Note 1 to entry: Fairness can be described as acting free from *bias* (3.23) towards any gender, age, race, ethnicity, specific groups of people (including individuals with disabilities) or any other identified characteristic.

3.23

bias

presence of any factors that can unfairly influence certification outcomes

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3.24

validity

evidence that an *assessment* (3.12) measures what it is intended to measure, as defined by the *certification scheme* (3.2)

Note 1 to entry: In this document, validity is also used in its adjective form "valid".

3.25

reliability

extent to which *examination* (3.13) scores are consistent across different examination times and locations, different examination forms and different *examiners* (3.14)

3.26

appeal

request by *applicant* (3.18), *candidate* (3.19) or *certified person* (3.20) for reconsideration of any decision made by the *certification body* (3.7) related to their desired certification status

3.27

complaint

expression of dissatisfaction, other than *appeal* (3.26), by any individual or organization to a *certification body* (3.7), relating to the activities of that body or a *certified person* (3.20), where a response is expected

3.28

interested party

person or organization with a direct or indirect interest in the performance of a *certification body* (3.7) or a *certified person* (3.20), or in the *certification scheme* (3.2)

Note 1 to entry: Interested parties can include the certified persons, conformity assessment bodies, associations and clients, industry and trade associations, *scheme owners* (3.3), employers of the certified persons, regulatory authorities, non-governmental organizations, consumers, or consumer organizations.

3.29

surveillance

periodic monitoring, during the validity period of certification, of a *certified person's* (3.20) performance to ensure continued compliance with the *certification scheme* (3.2)

3.30

recertification

process for certification renewal to confirm continued *competence* (3.9) of a *certified person* (3.20)

3.31

artificial intelligence

AI

autonomous system that performs functions normally associated with human intelligence, such as reasoning, learning and self-improvement

4 General requirements

4.1 Legal matters

The certification body shall be a legal entity, or a defined part of a legal entity, such that it can be held legally responsible for its certification activities. A governmental certification body is deemed to be a legal entity on the basis of its governmental status.

4.2 Responsibility for decision on certification

The certification body shall be responsible for, shall retain authority for, and shall not delegate, its decisions relating to certification, including the granting, maintaining, recertifying, expanding and reducing the scope of the certification, and suspending, reinstating or withdrawing the certification.

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4.3 Management of impartiality

4.3.1 Certification activities shall be undertaken impartially. The certification body shall document its structure, policies and procedures to manage impartiality and to ensure that the certification activities are undertaken impartially.

4.3.2 The certification body shall have top management commitment to impartiality. The certification body shall have a statement publicly available without request that it understands the importance of impartiality in carrying out its certification activities, manages conflicts of interest and ensures the objectivity of its certification activities.

4.3.3 The certification body shall act impartially in relation to its applicants, candidates and certified persons.

4.3.4 Policies and procedures for certification of persons shall be fair for all applicants, candidates and certified persons.

4.3.5 When a certification body uses artificial intelligence (AI) to carry out any certification activity, it shall document and demonstrate how it eliminates, minimizes or manages any risks to impartiality (e.g. bias).

4.3.6 The certification body shall not unfairly impede or inhibit access by applicants and candidates. Certification shall not be restricted on the grounds of undue financial or other limiting conditions, such as membership of an association or group.

4.3.7 The certification body shall be responsible for the impartiality of its certification activities and shall not allow commercial, financial or other pressures to compromise its impartiality.

4.3.8 The certification body shall monitor its activities and its relationships to identify threats to its impartiality on an ongoing basis. The monitoring shall include the relationships of its personnel and its related bodies.

NOTE 1 A relationship can be based on ownership, governance, management, personnel, shared resources, finances, contracts or marketing (including branding), and payment of a sales commission or other inducement for the referral of new applicants, etc. Such relationships do not necessarily present a body with a threat to impartiality.

NOTE 2 A related body is one which is linked to the certification body by common ownership, in whole or part, or has common members of the board of directors, contractual arrangements, common names, common staff, informal understanding or other means, such that the related body has a vested interest in any certification decision or has a potential ability to influence the certification process.

NOTE 3 Threats to impartiality can be either actual or perceived.

4.3.9 If a threat to impartiality is identified, its effect shall be eliminated or minimized so that the impartiality is not compromised.

4.3.10 The certification body shall identify, analyse, monitor, document and eliminate or minimize potential conflicts of interest arising from its certification activities. The certification body shall document and be able to demonstrate how it eliminates, minimizes or manages such conflicts of interest. All potential sources of conflicts of interest that are identified, whether they arise from within the certification body, such as assigning responsibilities to personnel, or from the activities of other persons, bodies or organizations, shall be covered.

4.4 Finance and liability

The certification body shall have the financial resources necessary for the operation of certification activities and have adequate arrangements (e.g. insurance or reserves) to cover associated liabilities.

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5 Structural requirements

5.1 Management and organizational structure

5.1.1 The certification body shall be structured and managed so as to safeguard impartiality.

5.1.2 The certification body shall document its organizational structure, describing the duties, responsibilities and authorities of management, its personnel and any committees. When the certification body is a defined part of a legal entity, documentation of the organizational structure shall include the line of authority and the relationship to other parts within the same legal entity.

The certification body shall determine responsibility for the following:

- a) policies and procedures relating to the operation of the certification body;
- b) finances of the certification body;
- c) resources for certification activities;
- d) development and maintenance of the certification schemes;
- e) assessment activities;
- f) decisions on certification, including the granting, maintaining, recertifying, expanding, reducing, suspending, reinstating or withdrawing of the certification;
- g) contractual arrangements.

5.2 Structure of the certification body in relation to education or training

5.2.1 Completion of education or training may be a prerequisite for certification, however education or training prerequisites shall not compromise impartiality or reduce the certification requirements.

5.2.2 A certification body shall not state or imply that certification would be simpler, easier or less expensive if any specific education or training services are used.

5.2.3 Offering education or training and certification of persons within the same legal entity or a related body constitutes a threat to impartiality. In such a case the certification body shall:

- a) identify and document the associated threats to its impartiality on an ongoing basis: the certification body shall have a documented process to demonstrate how it eliminates or minimizes those threats;
- b) demonstrate that all processes performed by the certification body are independent of education or training to ensure that confidentiality, information security and impartiality are not compromised;
- c) not give the impression that the use of both services would provide any advantage to the applicant;
- d) not require the applicant to complete education or training offered within the same legal entity or related body as an exclusive prerequisite when alternative education or training with an equivalent outcome exists;
- e) ensure that personnel do not serve as an examiner or invigilator of a specific candidate they have trained unless the certification body can demonstrate how it controls for conflicts of interest and impartiality.

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6 Resource requirements

6.1 General requirements for personnel

6.1.1 The certification body shall manage and be responsible for the performance of all personnel involved in certification activities.

6.1.2 All personnel of the certification body that could influence the certification activities shall act impartially.

6.1.3 The certification body shall have access to a sufficient number of competent persons to perform its certification activities.

6.1.4 The certification body shall have a process for managing competence of its personnel.

6.1.5 The certification body shall specify the competence requirements for personnel involved in the certification process and shall have up to date documented information demonstrating competence of its personnel.

NOTE Documented information can include qualifications, certifications, training, education, skills, professional affiliations, professional status, competence and known conflicts of interest.

6.1.6 The certification body shall provide its personnel with documented instructions describing their duties and responsibilities. These instructions shall be kept up to date.

6.1.7 Personnel, including any committee members, contractors, personnel of external bodies or personnel acting on the certification body's behalf, shall keep confidential all information obtained or created during the performance of the body's certification activities, except where authorized by the applicant, candidate or certified person. The certification body shall be aware of applicable legal requirements which can require the disclosure of this type of information.

6.1.8 The certification body shall maintain records of its personnel's agreement to comply with the policies and procedures defined by the certification body, including those relating to confidentiality, impartiality and conflicts of interest.

6.1.9 When a certification body certifies a person it employs or it contracts, the certification body shall adopt procedures to maintain impartiality.

6.2 Personnel involved in assessment activities

6.2.1 General

The certification body shall require its personnel to declare potential or known conflicts of interest with any applicant, candidate or certified person.

6.2.2 Requirements for examiners

6.2.2.1 Examiners shall meet the requirements of the certification body. The selection and approval processes shall ensure that examiners:

- a) have competence in the field of examination;
- b) understand the relevant certification scheme;
- c) are able to apply the examination procedures and documents;

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- d) have the skills to conduct the examination;
- e) have declared any known conflicts of interest to ensure impartial judgements are made.

6.2.2.2 The certification body shall have procedures to ensure that where interpretation or translation is used by the examiner it does not affect the validity, reliability and fairness of the examination.

6.2.2.3 The certification body shall monitor the performance of the examiners and the reliability and fairness of the examiners' judgements. Where deficiencies are found, corrective actions shall be taken. The results of monitoring and any corrective actions taken shall be supported by evidence.

NOTE Monitoring procedures for examiners can include, for example, on-site observation, review of examiners' reports, feedback from candidates.

6.2.2.4 If an examiner has potential or known conflicts of interest in the examination of a candidate or certified person, the certification body shall undertake measures to ensure that the confidentiality and impartiality of the examination are not compromised. These measures shall be recorded.

6.2.3 Requirements for other personnel involved in the assessment

If other personnel involved in the assessment (e.g. invigilators, persons who develop content for examinations) have potential conflicts of interest in the assessment of a candidate or certified person, the certification body shall undertake measures to ensure that confidentiality and impartiality of the assessment are not compromised. These measures shall be recorded.

6.3 Outsourcing

6.3.1 The certification body shall have a legally enforceable agreement covering the arrangements, ensuring confidentiality and avoiding conflicts of interest, with each body that provides outsourced services related to certification activities.

NOTE For the purposes of this document, the terms "outsourcing" and "subcontracting" are considered to be synonyms.

6.3.2 When a certification body outsources services related to certification activities, the certification body shall:

- a) take full responsibility for all outsourced services;
- b) ensure that the body conducting outsourced services is competent and conforms to this document;
- c) assess and monitor the performance of the bodies conducting outsourced services in accordance with its documented procedures;
- d) have records to demonstrate that the bodies conducting outsourced services meet all requirements relevant to the outsourced services;
- e) maintain a list of the bodies conducting outsourced services.

6.4 Other resources

The certification body shall use adequate premises, including examination sites, equipment and resources for carrying out its certification activities.

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6.5 Use of artificial intelligence (AI) in the certification process

If artificial intelligence (AI) is used to perform any part of the certification process, the certification body shall:

- a) verify, manage and monitor AI on an ongoing basis to ensure the intended results;
- b) validate outcomes of AI with subject matter experts;
- c) ensure personnel have the necessary competence in the oversight and use of AI;
- d) provide human oversight of AI;

NOTE ISO/IEC 42105 provides additional information on human oversight.

- e) demonstrate the validity, reliability and fairness of the use of AI;
- f) disclose its use of AI and obtain acknowledgement by the individual (applicant, candidate or certified person), where communication or interaction with AI is performed.

7 Records and information requirements

7.1 Records of applicants, candidates and certified persons

7.1.1 The certification body shall maintain records of applicants, candidates and certified persons. The records shall confirm the status of a certified person. The records shall demonstrate that the certification or recertification has been effectively completed, particularly with respect to application forms, assessment reports (which include examination records) and other documented information relating to granting, maintaining, recertifying, expanding and reducing the scope, and suspending or withdrawing certification.

7.1.2 The records shall be identified, managed, safeguarded from unauthorized access, and disposed of in such a way as to ensure the integrity of the certification process and the confidentiality of the information. The records shall be kept for an appropriate period of time, for a minimum of one full certification cycle, or longer as required by recognition arrangements or other obligations.

7.2 Public information

7.2.1 The certification body shall provide information, upon request, as to whether an individual holds a current, valid certification and the scope of that certification.

7.2.2 The certification body shall make publicly available without request:

- a) scope of the certification;
- b) prerequisites, if applicable;
- c) application requirements;
- d) initial certification requirements;
- e) surveillance requirements, if applicable;
- f) recertification interval and requirements;
- g) description of the certification process, including the assessments.

7.2.3 Information provided by the certification body, including marketing or promotional communication, shall be accurate and not misleading.

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7.3 Confidentiality

7.3.1 The certification body shall establish documented policies and procedures for the maintenance and release of information.

7.3.2 The certification body shall have policies and procedures to ensure data privacy and data protection.

7.3.3 The certification body shall be responsible, through legally enforceable agreements, for the management of all information obtained or created during the performance of certification activities. The certification body shall inform the applicant, candidate or certified person, in advance, of the information it intends to place in the public domain. Except for information that the applicant, candidate or certified person makes publicly available, or when agreed between the certification body and applicant, candidate or certified person, all other information is considered proprietary information and shall be regarded as confidential.

7.3.4 When the certification body is required by law or authorized by contractual arrangements to release confidential information, the applicant, candidate or certified person concerned shall be notified of the information released, unless prohibited by law.

7.3.5 The certification body shall ensure that the activities of related bodies do not compromise confidentiality.

7.3.6 The certification body shall identify threats to the confidentiality of the information. If a threat is identified its effect shall be eliminated or minimized so that confidentiality is not compromised.

7.4 Security

7.4.1 The certification body shall establish and document policies and procedures necessary to ensure security throughout its certification activities and shall have measures in place to take corrective actions when security breaches occur.

7.4.2 The certification body shall identify security threats impacting the effectiveness of the certification activities including those associated with the use of technology. If a threat is identified, its effect shall be eliminated or minimized so that the security of the certification process is not compromised.

7.4.3 Policies and procedures related to security shall include provisions to ensure the security of examination materials, taking into account the following:

- a) the locations or handling of the materials (e.g. transportation, electronic delivery, disposal, storage, examination site);
- b) the nature of the materials (e.g. electronic, paper, test equipment);
- c) the steps in the examination process (e.g. development, administration, results reporting);
- d) the threats arising from repeated use of examination materials.

7.4.4 Certification bodies shall prevent fraudulent examination behaviour, unauthorized disclosure of examination material or other misconduct by:

- a) requiring candidates to sign a non-disclosure agreement or other agreement indicating their commitment not to release confidential examination materials or participate in fraudulent practices;
- b) conducting invigilation; invigilation in real time shall be required unless the certification body can demonstrate how the other requirements of this clause are met;
- c) confirming the identity of the candidate, as part of the examination;

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- d) implementing procedures to prevent any unauthorized aids from being brought into the examination;
- e) preventing candidates from gaining access to unauthorized aids during the examination;
- f) monitoring examination results for indications of cheating.

7.4.5 The certification body shall identify the threats to the security of examination materials. If a threat is identified, its effect shall be eliminated or minimized so that the integrity of the examination materials is not compromised.

8 Certification schemes

8.1 There shall be a certification scheme for each category of certification of persons.

8.2 A certification scheme shall contain the following:

- a) scope of certification;
- b) job and task description;
- c) required competence;
- d) required abilities (if applicable);
- e) prerequisites (if applicable);
- f) code of conduct (if applicable).

NOTE 1 Abilities can include physical capabilities such as vision, hearing and mobility.

NOTE 2 Prerequisites can be specific qualifications, work experience, etc. and can be met at application or anytime before the certification decision.

NOTE 3 A code of conduct describes the ethical or personal behaviour required by the certification scheme.

8.3 A certification scheme shall include the following certification process requirements:

- a) criteria for initial certification and recertification;
- b) assessment methods for initial certification and recertification;
- c) surveillance methods and criteria (if applicable);
- d) criteria for suspending and withdrawing certification;
- e) criteria for changing the scope or level of certification (if applicable).

8.4 The certification body shall demonstrate that, in the development and review of the certification scheme, the following are included:

- a) the involvement of subject matter experts;
- b) the use of a structure that fairly represents the interests of the interested parties significantly concerned, without any interest predominating;
- c) the identification and alignment of prerequisites, if applicable, with the competence requirements;
- d) the identification and alignment of the assessment mechanisms with the competence requirements;
- e) a job or practice analysis that is conducted and updated to:
 - 1) identify the tasks for successful performance;

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- 2) identify the required competence for each task;
- 3) identify prerequisites (if applicable);
- 4) confirm the assessment mechanisms and examination content;
- 5) identify the recertification requirements and interval.

NOTE Where the certification scheme has been developed by a body other than the certification body, the job or practice analysis could already be available as part of that work. In this case, the certification body can obtain details from the certification scheme documentation for verification.

8.5 The certification body shall ensure that the certification scheme is reviewed and validated on an ongoing, systematic basis.

8.6 When the certification body is not the owner of a certification scheme it implements, the certification body shall ensure that the requirements specified in this clause are met.

9 Certification process requirements

9.1 Assessment process

9.1.1 The certification body shall implement the specific assessment methods and mechanisms as defined in the certification scheme.

9.1.2 When there is a change in the certification scheme which requires additional assessment, the certification body shall document and make publicly available without request the specific methods and mechanisms required to verify that certified persons comply with changed requirements.

NOTE Recertification or surveillance can be used to achieve this verification.

9.1.3 The assessment shall be planned and structured in a manner which ensures that the certification requirements are objectively and systematically verified with documented evidence to confirm the competence of the candidate.

9.1.4 The certification body shall verify the methods for assessing candidates. This verification shall ensure that each assessment is fair, valid and reliable.

9.1.5 The certification body shall verify and accommodate specific needs, within reason and where the validity and fairness of the assessment is not compromised [see [9.2.2 e](#)].

9.1.6 Where the certification body takes into account work performed by another body, it shall have appropriate reports, data and records to demonstrate that the results are equivalent to, and conform with, the requirements established by the certification scheme.

9.1.7 In circumstances where interpretation or translation is used, the certification body shall have procedures in place to ensure that it does not affect the validity, reliability and fairness of the assessment.

9.2 Application process

9.2.1 As part of the application process, the certification body shall make available an overview of the certification process in accordance with the certification scheme. As a minimum, the overview shall include the requirements for certification and its scope, a description of the assessment process, the applicant's rights, the duties of a certified person and the fees.

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9.2.2 The certification body shall require the completion of an application, with the agreement of the applicant, which includes as a minimum the following:

- a) information required to identify the applicant, such as name, address and other information required by the certification scheme;
- b) the scope of the desired certification;
- c) a statement that the applicant agrees to comply with the certification requirements and to provide any information needed for the assessment;
- d) any supporting information to objectively demonstrate compliance with the application prerequisites;
- e) notice to the applicant of the opportunity to declare, within reason, a request for accommodation of specific needs (see [9.1.5](#)).

NOTE Accommodation of specific needs can include modification of assessment methods or its administration to account for the effects of a disability.

9.2.3 The certification body shall review the application to confirm that the applicant complies with the application requirements of the certification scheme.

9.3 Examination process

9.3.1 Examinations shall be designed to assess competence based on, and consistent with, the certification scheme, by written, oral, practical, observational or other reliable and objective means. The design of the examination shall ensure the comparability of results of each single examination, both in content and difficulty, including the validity of fail/pass decisions. Evidence of the comparability of results shall be available to ensure equity, fairness and consistent results.

9.3.2 The certification body shall have procedures to ensure consistent administration of examinations.

9.3.3 Criteria and conditions for administering examinations shall be established, documented and monitored.

NOTE Conditions can include lighting, temperature, separation of candidates, noise, candidate safety, network characteristics, IT equipment, etc.

9.3.4 When technical equipment is used in the examination process, the equipment shall be fit for purpose, and calibrated where appropriate.

9.3.5 The certification body shall document and implement appropriate methodology and procedures (e.g. collecting and maintaining statistical data) in order to reaffirm, at justified defined intervals, the fairness, validity, reliability and general performance of each examination, and that all identified deficiencies are corrected.

9.4 Decision on certification

9.4.1 The information gathered during the certification process shall be reviewed and be sufficient:

- a) for the certification body to make a decision on certification;
- b) for traceability in the event, for example, of an appeal or a complaint.

9.4.2 Decisions for granting, maintaining, recertifying, extending, reducing, suspending, reinstating or withdrawing certification shall not be outsourced.

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9.4.3 The certification body shall confine its decision on certification to those matters specifically related to the certification requirements.

9.4.4 The decision on certification shall be made solely by the certification body on the basis of the information gathered during the certification process. Personnel who make the decision on certification shall not have participated in the examination or training of the candidate.

9.4.5 The personnel who make certification decisions shall have the competence required to determine if the certification requirements have been met.

9.4.6 Certification shall not be granted until all certification requirements are fulfilled.

9.4.7 The certification body shall provide a certificate to all certified persons. The certification body shall maintain sole ownership of the certificates. The certificate shall take the form of a document, card or other medium, authorized by a responsible member of the personnel of the certification body.

9.4.8 The certificate shall contain, as a minimum, the following information:

- a) the name of the certified person;
- b) a unique identification;
- c) the name and contact information of the certification body;
- d) a reference to the certification scheme, standard or other relevant documents; this shall also include the issue date or version, if relevant;
- e) the scope of the certification including, if applicable, conditions and limitations;
- f) the effective date of certification and date of expiry.

NOTE 1 The effective date of initial certification can be the date of the certification decision or after the decision.

NOTE 2 When recertification activities are successfully completed prior to the expiry date of the existing certification, the expiry date of the new certification can be based on the expiry date of the existing certification. The issue date on a new certificate can be on or after the recertification decision.

9.4.9 The certificate shall be designed to reduce the risk of counterfeiting.

9.5 Suspending, withdrawing or reducing the scope of certification

9.5.1 The certification body shall have a policy and documented procedures for suspension or withdrawal of the certification, or reduction of the scope of certification, which shall specify the subsequent actions by the certification body.

9.5.2 Failure to resolve the issues that have resulted in the suspension, in a time established by the certification body, shall result in withdrawal of the certification or reduction of the scope of certification.

9.5.3 The certification body shall have legally enforceable agreements with the certified person to ensure that, in the event of suspension of certification, the certified person refrains from further promotion of the certification while it is suspended.

9.5.4 The certification body shall have legally enforceable agreements with the certified person to ensure that, in the event of withdrawal of certification, the certified person discontinues use of all references to a certified status.

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9.6 Recertification process

9.6.1 The certification body shall have documented procedures for implementation of the recertification process, in accordance with the certification scheme requirements.

9.6.2 The certification body shall ensure during the recertification process that it confirms continued competence of the certified person and ongoing compliance with current certification requirements by the certified person.

9.6.3 The recertification interval shall be in accordance with the certification scheme requirements. The rationale for the recertification interval shall take into account, where applicable, the following:

- a) regulatory requirements;
- b) changes to normative documents;
- c) changes in the relevant certification scheme requirements;
- d) the nature and maturity of the industry or field in which the certified person is working;
- e) the risks resulting from an incompetent person;
- f) ongoing changes in technology, and requirements for certified persons;
- g) requirements of interested parties;
- h) the frequency and content of surveillance activities, if required by the certification scheme.

9.6.4 In accordance with the certification scheme, recertification by the certification body shall consider at least the following:

- a) on-site assessment;
- b) professional development;

NOTE 1 “Professional development” can include activities undertaken by a certified person to maintain, improve or increase knowledge and skills related to professional activities.
- c) structured interviews;
- d) confirmation of continuing satisfactory work and work experience records;
- e) examination;
- f) checks on physical capability in relation to the competence concerned.

NOTE 2 “Physical capability” can require an evaluation by a health professional, or by a professional qualified to evaluate physical abilities such as dexterity, strength and endurance, as well as the technical performance skills required for the certification.

9.6.5 The recertification activities shall be adequate to ensure that there is impartial assessment to confirm the continuing competence of the certified person.

NOTE Activities supported only by a self-declaration by the certified person do not constitute an impartial assessment.

9.7 Use of certificates and marks

9.7.1 A certification body that provides a certification mark shall document the conditions for use and shall appropriately manage the rights for usage and representation.

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NOTE ISO/IEC 17030 provides requirements for use of third-party marks.

9.7.2 The certification body shall require that a certified person agrees to the following:

- a) to comply with the certification requirements;
- b) to make claims regarding certification only with respect to the scope for which certification has been granted;
- c) not to use the certification in such a manner as to bring the certification body into disrepute;
- d) not to make any statement regarding the certification which the certification body considers misleading or unauthorized;
- e) to discontinue the use of all claims to certification that contain any reference to the certification body or certification upon suspension or withdrawal of certification, and to return any certificates issued by the certification body;
- f) not to use the certificate in a misleading manner;
- g) to inform the certification body, without delay, of matters that can affect the capability of the certified person to continue to fulfil the certification requirements.

9.7.3 A certification body shall address, by means of corrective measures, any misuse of its certification mark.

9.8 Appeals against decisions on certification

9.8.1 The certification body shall have a documented procedure for handling appeals that shall include at least the following:

- a) a description of the process for receiving and investigating the appeal, and deciding what actions shall be taken in response;
- b) tracking and recording the appeal, including the actions undertaken to resolve it;
- c) ensuring appropriate action is taken.

9.8.2 The policies and procedures shall ensure that all appeals are dealt with in an impartial and timely manner.

9.8.3 A description of the process for handling appeals shall be publicly available without request.

9.8.4 The certification body receiving the appeal shall be responsible for gathering all necessary information to determine whether the appeal is valid.

9.8.5 The certification body shall be responsible for all decisions during the process for handling appeals.

9.8.6 The decision on the appeal shall be made by, or reviewed and approved by, persons not involved in the decision that is the subject of the appeal in question.

9.8.7 Submission, investigation and decision on appeals shall not result in any discriminatory actions against the appellant.

9.8.8 The certification body shall acknowledge receipt of the appeal, and provide the appellant with the outcome and, if applicable, progress reports.

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9.8.9 The certification body shall give formal notice to the appellant of the end of the appeals-handling process.

9.9 Complaints

9.9.1 The certification body shall have a documented procedure for handling complaints that shall include at least the following:

- a) a description of the process for receiving, substantiating and investigating the complaint, and deciding what actions shall be taken in response;
- b) tracking and recording the complaint, including the actions undertaken to resolve it;
- c) ensuring appropriate action is taken.

The procedures shall ensure that the certification body treats all parties fairly and equitably.

9.9.2 The policies and procedures shall ensure that all complaints are handled and processed in a constructive, impartial and timely manner.

9.9.3 A description of the process for handling complaints shall be publicly available without request.

9.9.4 The certification body receiving the complaint shall be responsible for gathering all necessary information to determine whether the complaint is substantiated.

9.9.5 Upon receipt of a complaint, the certification body shall confirm whether the complaint relates to its certification activities and, if so, shall resolve the complaint.

9.9.6 The certification body shall inform the certified person of any substantiated complaint at an appropriate time.

9.9.7 The complaints-handling process shall be subject to requirements for confidentiality, as it relates to the complainant and to the subject of the complaint.

9.9.8 The resolution of complaints shall be made by, or reviewed and approved by, persons not involved in the subject of the complaint in question. Where resources do not permit this, any alternative approach shall not compromise impartiality.

9.9.9 Investigation and resolution of complaints shall not result in any discriminatory actions.

9.9.10 Whenever possible, the certification body shall acknowledge receipt of the complaint, and provide the complainant with the outcome and, if applicable, progress reports.

9.9.11 The certification body shall give formal notice of the end of the complaints-handling process to the complainant.

10 Management system requirements

10.1 General

10.1.1 The certification body shall establish, document, implement and maintain a management system to support and demonstrate the consistent fulfilment of the requirements of this document.

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10.1.2 The management system of the certification body shall include at least the following:

- policies and responsibilities ([10.2](#));
- management review ([10.3](#));
- internal audits ([10.4](#));
- corrective actions ([10.5](#));
- actions to address risks and opportunities ([10.6](#));
- documented information ([10.7](#)).

10.1.3 A certification body may meet [10.1.2](#) by establishing, implementing and maintaining a quality management system (e.g. in accordance with the requirements of ISO 9001). This quality management system shall support and demonstrate the consistent fulfilment of the requirements of this document.

10.2 Policies and responsibilities

10.2.1 The certification body's top management shall establish and document policies and objectives for its activities.

10.2.2 The top management shall provide evidence of its commitment to the development, implementation and maintenance of the management system in accordance with the requirements of this document. The top management shall ensure that the policies and objectives are understood, implemented and maintained at all levels of the certification body's organization.

10.2.3 The certification body's top management shall appoint a member of management who, irrespective of other responsibilities, shall have responsibility and authority that include:

- a) ensuring that processes and procedures needed for the management system are established, implemented and maintained;
- b) reporting to top management on the performance of the management system and any need for improvement.

10.3 Management review

10.3.1 General

The certification body's top management shall review its management system at planned intervals, in order to ensure its continuing suitability, adequacy and effectiveness, including the stated policies and objectives related to the fulfilment of the requirements of this document. These reviews shall be conducted at least annually and shall be documented.

10.3.2 Review input

The input to the management review shall include information related to the following:

- a) results of internal and external audits (e.g. accreditation body assessment);
- b) feedback from applicants, candidates, certified persons and interested parties related to the fulfilment of the requirements of this document;
- c) actions to safeguard impartiality;
- d) the status of actions to address risks and opportunities;
- e) follow-up actions from previous management reviews;

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- f) the fulfilment of objectives;
- g) changes that could affect the management system;
- h) appeals and complaints.

10.3.3 Review output

The output from the management review shall include as a minimum decisions and actions related to the following:

- a) improvement of the effectiveness of the management system and its processes;
- b) improvement of the certification services related to the fulfilment of the requirements of this document;
- c) resource needs.

10.4 Internal audits

10.4.1 The certification body shall conduct internal audits to determine that it fulfils the requirements of this document and to verify that the management system is effectively implemented and maintained.

NOTE ISO 19011 provides guidelines for auditing of management systems.

10.4.2 An audit programme shall be planned, taking into consideration the importance of the processes and areas to be audited, as well as the results of previous audits.

10.4.3 Internal audits shall be performed at least annually. The frequency of internal audits may be reduced if the certification body demonstrates that its management system continues to be effectively implemented in accordance with this document and has proven stability.

10.4.4 The certification body shall ensure that:

- a) internal audits are performed by competent personnel, knowledgeable in the certification process, auditing and the requirements of this document;
- b) auditors do not audit their own work;
- c) personnel responsible for the area audited are informed of the outcome of the audit;
- d) any actions resulting from internal audits are taken in a timely and appropriate manner;
- e) any opportunities for improvement are identified.

10.5 Corrective actions

The certification body shall identify and manage nonconformities in its operations. The certification body shall also, where necessary, take actions to eliminate the causes of nonconformities in order to prevent recurrence. Corrective actions shall be appropriate to the impact of the problems encountered. The certification body shall specify requirements for the following:

- a) identifying nonconformities;
- b) determining the cause(s) of nonconformity;
- c) correcting nonconformities;
- d) evaluating the need for actions to ensure that nonconformities do not recur or occur elsewhere;
- e) determining and implementing the actions needed in a timely manner;

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- f) recording the results of actions taken;
- g) reviewing the effectiveness of corrective actions.

10.6 Actions to address risks and opportunities

10.6.1 The certification body shall consider the risks and opportunities associated with the certification activities in order to:

- a) give assurance that the management system achieves its intended results;
- b) enhance opportunities to achieve the objectives of the certification body;
- c) prevent or reduce undesired impacts and potential failures in the certification activities;
- d) identify potential nonconformities and their causes;
- e) achieve improvement.

10.6.2 The certification body shall ensure that actions:

- a) are planned and taken to address risks and opportunities;
- b) are integrated into its management system;
- c) are evaluated for effectiveness.

NOTE Although this document requires that the certification body plans actions to address risks and opportunities, there is no requirement for formal methods for risk management or a documented risk management process. Certification bodies can decide whether or not to develop a more extensive risk management methodology than is required by this document (e.g. through the application of other guidance documents or standards, such as ISO 31000 and IEC 31010).

10.6.3 Actions taken to address risks and opportunities shall be proportional to the potential impact on the certification activities.

NOTE Options to address risks can include identifying and avoiding threats, taking risk in order to pursue an opportunity, eliminating the risk source, changing the likelihood or consequences, sharing the risk, or retaining risk by informed decision.

10.7 Documented information

10.7.1 The certification body shall ensure that the management system is accessible to all relevant personnel.

10.7.2 The certification body shall control the documents (internal and external) that relate to the fulfilment of the requirements of this document. The certification body shall ensure that:

- a) documents are approved for adequacy prior to issue by authorized personnel;
- b) documents are periodically reviewed, and updated as necessary;
- c) changes and the current revision status of documents are identified;
- d) relevant versions of applicable documents are available at points of use and, where necessary, their distribution is controlled;
- e) documents are uniquely identified;
- f) the unintended use of obsolete documents is prevented, and suitable identification is applied to them if they are retained for any purpose.

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NOTE Documented information can be documents or records in any form or type of medium.

10.7.3 The certification body shall control the identification, storage, protection, retrieval, retention time and disposition of its records related to the fulfilment of the requirements of this document.

10.7.4 The certification body shall retain records for a period consistent with its contractual and legal obligations. Access to these records shall be consistent with the confidentiality arrangements.

NOTE For requirements for records on applicants, candidates and certified persons, see also [7.1](#).

Annex A

(informative)

Principles for certification of persons

A.1 General

A.1.1 This document does not give specific requirements for all situations that can occur. These principles should be applied as guidance for the decisions that could be taken for unanticipated situations. Principles are not requirements.

A.1.2 The overall purpose of certification of persons is to recognize an individual's competence to perform a task or job.

A.1.3 The certification body has a responsibility to ensure that only those persons who demonstrate competence are awarded certification.

A.1.4 Certification of persons provides value through public confidence and trust. Public confidence relies on a fair, valid and reliable assessment of competence, by a third party, reconfirmed at defined intervals.

A.1.5 The certification body should act in a responsible manner so as to provide confidence to interested parties in its competence, impartiality and integrity.

A.2 Impartiality

A.2.1 Certification of a person should be based on objective evidence obtained by the certification body through a fair, valid and reliable assessment, and not influenced by other interests or by other parties.

A.2.2 It is necessary for certification bodies and their personnel to be and to be perceived as being impartial in order to give confidence in their activities and their outcomes.

A.2.3 Threats to impartiality include, but are not limited to, the following:

- a) self-interest threats: threats that arise from a person or body acting in their own interest to benefit themselves;
- b) subjectivity threats: threats that arise when personal bias overrules objective evidence;
- c) familiarity threats: threats that arise from a person being familiar with or trusting another person, e.g. an examiner or certification body personnel developing a relationship with a candidate that affects the ability to reach an objective judgement;
- d) intimidation threats: threats that prevent a certification body or its personnel from acting objectively due to fear of a candidate or other interested party;
- e) financial threats: the source of revenue for a certification body can be a threat to impartiality.

A.3 Competence

Competence of the personnel of the certification body is necessary to operate certification of persons that provides confidence.

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A.4 Confidentiality and openness

Managing the balance between confidentiality and openness affects interested parties' trust and their perception of value in the certification activities.

A.5 Responsiveness to complaints and appeals

The effective resolution of complaints and appeals is an important means of protection for the certification body and interested parties against errors, omissions or unreasonable behaviour.

A.6 Responsibility

The certification body has the responsibility to obtain sufficient objective evidence upon which to base a certification decision.

Annex B (informative)

Relationship between certification activities

[Figure B.1](#) provides a visual representation of the relationship between several of the activities described in this document.

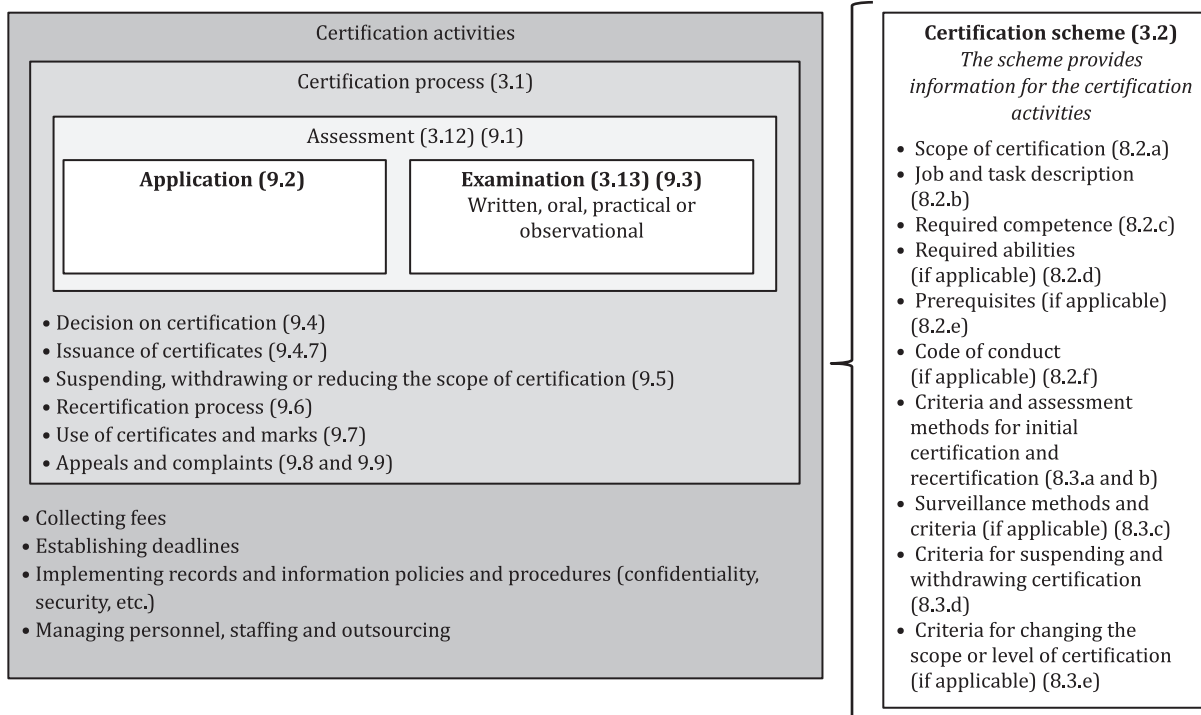


Figure B.1 — Relationship between certification activities

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Bibliography

- [1] ISO 9001, *Quality management systems — Requirements*
- [2] ISO 19011, *Guidelines for auditing management systems*
- [3] ISO/IEC 17030, *Conformity assessment — General requirements for third-party marks of conformity*
- [4] ISO/IEC 42105, *Information technology — Artificial intelligence — Guidance for human oversight of AI systems*
- [5] ISO 31000, *Risk management — Guidelines*
- [6] IEC 31010, *Risk management — Risk assessment techniques*



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